

# CHRISTOPHER VAN DER MERWE

IT Support Specialist | Technical Support | Front-End Web Developer

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Portfolio | GitHub | LinkedIn

## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

IT Support Specialist with over 10 years of freelance experience delivering desktop support, hardware diagnostics, Windows deployment, Microsoft 365 configuration, networking assistance and remote technical support. Proven ability to diagnose and resolve technical issues while providing excellent customer service. Complementing a strong IT support background with practical front-end web development experience, including designing and deploying responsive web applications using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git and GitHub Pages. Currently expanding technical expertise through Full-Stack Software Engineering and Cybersecurity studies while seeking a remote opportunity with an international or distributed team.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

## SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

Delivered over 10 years of paid freelance IT support services to private clients.

Repaired, upgraded or deployed 80+ desktop and laptop systems.

Designed, developed and deployed a 6-page responsive portfolio website using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git and GitHub Pages.

Completed 20+ technical courses while progressing through the Codecademy Full-Stack Engineer Career Path.

Built and published a growing portfolio of responsive web development projects using modern HTML, CSS and JavaScript best practices.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance IT Support Technician | Self-Employed | Jan 2014 - Present

Delivered paid IT support services to private clients across hardware, software and networking requirements.

Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software and connectivity issues both on-site and remotely.

Installed, configured and maintained Windows XP through Windows 11 systems.

Built, repaired and upgraded 80+ desktop and laptop computers.

Configured Microsoft 365, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, printers, routers and remote support tools.

Performed BIOS configuration, driver installation, SSD migrations and hardware diagnostics.

Senior Restaurant Manager | Various Hospitality Roles | 2008 – 2014

Managed staff, customer service, scheduling, reporting and daily operations in busy hospitality environments.

Contract Boilermaker | Steinmüller | 2006 - 2007

Performed industrial fabrication, maintenance and repair while following safety and quality standards.

## TECHNICAL PORTFOLIO

Professional Portfolio Website | HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Git, GitHub Pages

Designed and developed a 6-page responsive portfolio website.

Built reusable header and footer components shared across all pages.

Implemented responsive navigation for desktop and mobile devices.

Managed version control with Git using feature branches, merges and deployment workflow.

Deployed and maintained the website using GitHub Pages.

Showcases 10+ responsive web development projects and technical documentation.

Responsive Web Development Projects: Built multiple responsive websites and JavaScript projects demonstrating semantic HTML, Flexbox, CSS Grid, accessibility, animations and modern UI practices.

## **PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT**

Completed: HTML, CSS, Intermediate CSS, Flexbox, CSS Grid, Responsive Design, Accessibility, Browser Compatibility, JavaScript, C#, Lua, Cybersecurity and AI courses.

Currently Studying: Full-Stack Engineer Career Path, Introduction to Ethical Hacking, Prompt Engineering.

## **EDUCATION**

Hendrina Combined School - Secondary Education

## **ADDITIONAL INFORMATION**

Code 10 Driver's Licence | Fluent in English & Afrikaans | Seeking primarily remote opportunities with international or distributed teams.